

The Jews and the United Nations

By Abraham Chapman

I have received a number of letters from friends of the Emergency Committee to Save the Jewish People of Europe disputing my articles in the Morning Freiheit and the Daily Worker, which criticized the anti-United Nations activities of the organizers of this Emergency Committee. (My articles did not attack the entire committee).

The appeal of the Emergency Committee — to save the Jewish people of Europe—is one which immediately arouses a warm response in every American and every anti-fascist. That is why so many prominent patriotic Americans have lent their names to the Emergency Committee. But the handful of irresponsible organizers of the Emergency Committee persist in very dangerous criticism of the leading governments of the anti-Hitler coalition. That is why I welcome the opportunity to clarify further our criticism of the organizers of the Emergency Committee.

CONSCIOUS MOTIVE

I have before me the Dec. 5 issue of *The Answer*, the mouthpiece of the Emergency Committee. Among the editorials in this issue I find a name for herself on the

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Committee are trying to blur the line of demarcation between the anti-Hitler camp and the Axis. They are trying to make the United Nations responsible for the Nazi crimes against the Jewish people, instead of advocating a constructive course of action which will actually rescue Jews.

The organizers of the Emergency Committee are more interested in criticizing the White House, the State Department and the United Nations than in actually rescuing Jews. This is a serious charge and it is meant in all earnestness. The fact of the matter is that there can be no rescue of the Jews short of the victory of the United Nations and the rapid realization of the decisions of the Moscow and Tehran conferences.

The American and British governments could have done more and should do more to rescue Jews and all anti-fascists support the demands of the American Jewish Conference for action by the American and British governments to rescue Jews. But the organizers of the Emergency Committee are not supporting the most important practical measures to rescue Jews.

On Monday, Dean Alfange, vice-chairman of the Emergency Committee, issued a statement in behalf of the Committee attacking the State Department. Many progressives, including the Morning Freiheit and the Daily Worker, realize that America should allow more victims of Nazi persecution into the United States. But Dean Alfange's statement is very remarkable indeed: Alfange attacks the State Department for its attitude to Jewish refugees and then refuses to urge upon the American government any necessity for admitting Jewish refugees into the United States. Alfange specifically says:

"We do not seek to admit a single Jewish refugee to the U. S."

ATTACK ON U.S.S.R.

In a radio broadcast the other day Dean Alfange had the audacity

to urge that the Soviet Union do more than it has done to rescue Jewish refugees. The Soviet Union has rescued close to two million Jews from the clutches of the Nazis! But Dean Alfange plays right into the hands of the defeatists, stating that he **doesn't** urge America to admit any refugees, but he only wants the Soviet Union to take in **more** refugees. The Hearsts and Hoovers do not support the proposition of any effort to get the United States to admit more refugees. They only attack the U.S. government for not rescuing Jewish refugees and then turn around and attack the Soviet Union for rescuing **only** 1,800,000 Jews!

Bergson reveals his complete lack of confidence in the United Nations as well as his adherence to the old guard school of Revisionist terrorism, when he says:

"After this war is over, there will not only be a very large immigration into Palestine, but there will also be a small emigration from Palestine—a small emigration of sturdy Hebrew youths who will find their way into Europe and execute justice. They will take care of every Nazi that has murdered a Jew in the same manner which Shalom Schwartzbard took care of Petlura."

The Emergency Committee takes pride, in large advertisements, that it was the **first** to protest against the historic and significant declaration on Nazi atrocities signed by Roosevelt, Stalin and Churchill. And the leader of the Emergency Committee, Peter Bergson, can only offer individual terrorism, in place of organized trials by the people, against the Nazi criminals. And the Bergsons expect the Jewish people to accept a plea for personal terrorism as against the solemn declarations of the leading governments of the United Nations to punish the Nazi criminals—including their crimes against the Jewish people. But the Bergsons are **mistaken**.